
Inspection of a vehicle through mVahan app

EASE OF DRIVE

The transport department of Assam has ensured smooth service delivery through online mode

- 40 contactless, online services–23 under Vahan software related to vehicles and route permits and 17 under Sarathi software related to driving license
- 14,500 Common Service Centres for providing online and contactless transport services to citizens
- Nearly 6,000 vehicle fitness certificates issued through mVahan in just July 2022

900,000 have benefitted from digital initiatives by Assam transport department, saving 2.7 million man-days

The introduction of the CM – Transport Randomised Allocation Networked System (CM-Trans) in the transport department is the most unique digital initiative of Assam government. This pioneering initiative ushers in a mechanism which not only provides online application and disposal facilities to citizens but also uniformly distributes workload among all district transport offices (DTO) to increase the speed and efficiency of service deliverance. A brainchild of Chief Minister Sarma, it's the first such system launched in any state of India.

The new system, launched on May 13, 2022, does away with the concept of verification and approval of applications in the same DTO where it has been submitted. Instead, it randomly allocates an application to any of the 32 DTOs of Assam based on their individual workload. The application is automatically routed to the DTOs where the pendency is comparatively less. This uniform distribution of work ensures greater efficiency and faster delivery. The applicant and the DTO, in which he or she submitted the application, do not get to know which DTO has been allocated the responsibility of processing the application. This ensures complete elimination of the role of the middle men and unnecessary harassment of applicants.

The transport department has also taken several other digital initiatives—14,500 Common Service Centres for 40 online and contactless transport services to citizens, e-challan in all districts, online approval for vehicle scrapping and mVahan, a mobile-based app for fitness inspection and approval of commercial vehicles.

Apart from these major missions, digital technology has also been used to empower the citizen through the Right to Public Services (RRPS) portal launched by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman in Guwahati on October 7, 2021. The portal is part of the Assam Citizen-Centric Service Delivery Project, financed by the World Bank. Driven by the Right to Public Services Act, 2012, the RTPS portal aims to improve the accessibility in the delivery of select public services in the state. Through this web portal, the citizens can apply online for 150 notified public services and receive deliverance within a limited time frame.

The project aims at strengthening institutional operations, making citizens aware of their rights and encouraging their engagement and participation in the service delivery process. Some of these services include registration of property documents, marriage registration, duplicate vehicle registration and ownership transfer of a vehicle. Now, this service has been extended to the three Sixth Schedule districts—Bodoland Territorial Council, Dima Hasao Autonomous Territorial Council, and Karbi Anglong Autonomous Council. ■


CM Himanta Biswa Sarma at the launch of Mission Sadbhavana